

6 (a) Define electric potential at a point.

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.....

..... [2]

- (b) An isolated conducting sphere of radius R is in a vacuum. The sphere has a charge of $+Q$ distributed around its surface, as illustrated in Figure 6.1.

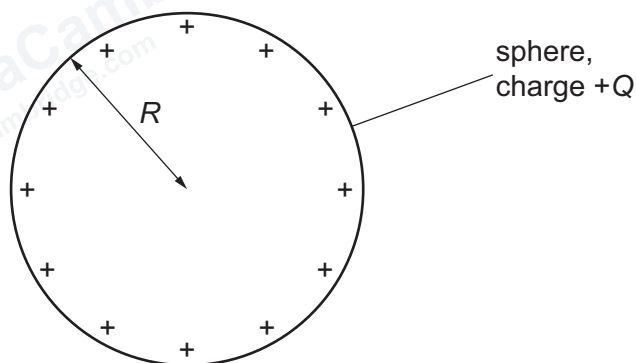


Figure 6.1

- (i) State an expression, in terms of R and Q , for the magnitude V_0 of the electric potential at the surface of the sphere. Identify any other symbols that you use.

$V_0 =$ [1]

- (ii) On Figure 6.2, sketch the variation of the electric potential V at distance x from the centre of the sphere between $x = R$ and $x = 3R$.

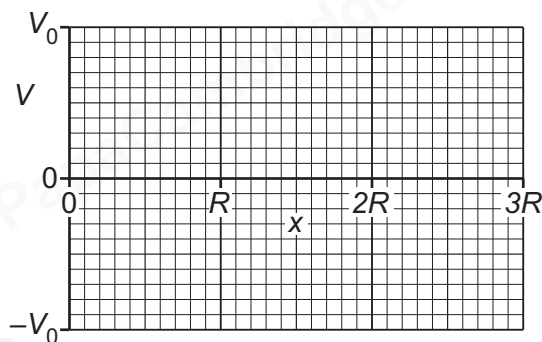


Figure 6.2

[3]

- (c) The dome of an electrostatic generator, called a Van de Graaff generator, may be considered to be a conducting sphere of radius 11.9 cm.

The dome is charged so that the electric potential at its surface is $-4.80 \times 10^4 \text{ V}$.

- (i) Calculate the charge on the surface of the dome.

charge = C [2]

- (ii) Explain why the dome acts as a capacitor.

.....
..... [1]

- (iii) Calculate the capacitance of the dome. Give a unit with your answer.

capacitance = unit [2]

- (iv) Determine the energy stored by the dome.

energy = J [2]

[Total: 13]